

Open-back tie-back mini dress

EU38 sewing guide . 7 pieces . 1.6 m fabric at 140 cm

text-first guide, no illustrations in this edition. Every step is the engine's own instruction.

Cut list

Bodice Front - cut 1 on fold

Bodice Back - cut 2

Skirt Front - cut 1 on fold

Skirt Back - cut 2 (center back seam)

Waist Tie (bel ba 1) - cut 2 rectangle(s) 90 x 630 mm (finished 30 x 600 mm), each ties from the side seam round to a bow at center

Open Back Facing (round) - cut 1 on fold, interface

Strips / notions (chalked on fabric, not printed)

Bias binding (neckline + armholes) - cut 1 strip(s) 1218 x 25 mm ON THE BIAS (45° to the grain), join end to end (total 1218 mm)

Steps

1. Print and check the 3 cm calibration square before cutting.
2. This block uses standard assumptions for shoulder slope, underbust - sew a quick muslin (test version) from cheap fabric first and adjust before cutting your real fabric.
3. Cut every piece as labelled: pieces marked 'on fold' on the fabric fold, 'cut 2' twice.
4. Staystitch the neckline just inside the seam line so it doesn't stretch while you work.
5. Sew all darts first, pressing toward the center.
6. Sew the bodice shoulder seams and press them open.
7. Prepare the neckline bias strip: join the ends as needed and press it in half lengthwise along the marked fold line.
8. Bind the neckline with the bias strip, right sides together and raw edges even, leaving the last 2 cm free at each center back edge (the zipper goes there later). Ease the strip gently around the curves. Trim to 6 mm, turn the folded edge to the inside and topstitch or slipstitch it down.
9. Sew the bodice side seams.
10. Finish each armhole the same way with its bias strip: press it in half, bind the armhole right sides together, ease around the curve, then turn and topstitch it to the inside.
11. Sew the skirt seams (leave the center back seam open where the zipper will go), then join bodice to skirt at the waist seam, matching side seams.
12. Insert an invisible zipper in the center back through bodice and skirt: install the zipper BEFORE closing the seam below it, then close the rest of the seam.

13. Fold the free binding ends back over the zipper tape and hand-tack them down so the edge sits clean against the zipper.
14. Try it on, then hem with a 2 cm double fold.
15. Ties (ba): cut the tie rectangle(s) as labelled, fold each in half lengthwise right sides together, stitch the long edge and one short end, turn right side out and press. Stitch the raw end to the marked placement notch (right sides together, caught in the seam), then knot into a bow. The tie is self-fabric cut on the straight grain.
16. Open back: fuse interfacing to the open-back facing and finish its outer edge.
17. Pin the open-back facing to the back RIGHT sides together, matching the marked round opening. Stitch exactly on the marked line all the way around.
18. Slash the opening inside the stitched line (through both layers); clip the curves and corners to within 2 mm of the stitching.
19. Turn the facing through the opening to the inside, roll the seam to the edge, press, then understitch or topstitch 2 mm from the opening edge.